NXTWAVE GROWTH INTERN CHALLENGE · GROWTH PLAN

500 final-year registrations in 7 days, on ₹2,000

Workshop: **Build Your First AI Project in 60 Minutes** · Free, live online, Sun 8 Nov, 11 AM IST · Campaign 1–7 Nov · Akilan

The bet: ₹2,000 can't buy 500 students' attention, but it can pay them to bring their friends.

- At an estimated ₹40–80 per student lead on paid social, ₹2,000 buys about 25–50 registrations, which is 5–10% of the goal.
- Final-year students already sit in free, dense distribution: batch WhatsApp groups, clubs and placement cells. Access is free; what's missing is a reason to share.
- So every registrant gets a personal invite link. The whole ₹2,000 becomes prizes for the top 3 referrers, paid only on results.

520	3	₹4	≥ 80%
planned registrations (4% buffer)	channels: champions, partners, referral loop	cost per registration at 500	final-year (2027 batch) share

01 Who we're targeting and what we promise

Who: 2027-batch B.E./B.Tech students in tier-2 and tier-3 colleges. All branches can join; CSE, IT and AI&DS come first.

Why now: November is placement season. Their most common gap is "I have no real project to talk about in interviews."

Promise: "Leave with a working AI project on your GitHub in 60 minutes, before your next interview." The pitch is the outcome, not "learn AI".

Timing: Sunday 11 AM, when there are no classes, labs or placement drives.

02 The math: three channels to 520

CHANNEL	HOW IT RUNS	REACH	CONV.	REGS
A. Student champions batch WhatsApp groups	25 champions at 25 colleges each post in their final-year group, every group with its own tracked link	25 × 240 = 6,000	4%	240
B. Partners clubs, placement cells, LinkedIn	12 partners (GDSC, IEEE, CSI, coding clubs, TPOs) post once through their official channel	12 × 250 = 3,000	3%	90
C. Referral loop every registrant	25% of registrants share, and each sharer brings 1.5 friends, so k ≈ 0.37. Total = 330 ÷ (1 − 0.37)	n/a	n/a	+190
Total (target 500, so a 4% buffer)				**520**

Sensitivity: if the loop only reaches k = 0.2, the total falls to about 410. The trigger is pace below 80% of plan by Day 3. The response is to recruit 8 more champions (about +80 seed registrations, plus their referrals). Each champion is worth about 10 seed registrations, so champions are the lever to pull first.

03 Budget: ₹2,000, paid only on results

ITEM	WHY	COST
Top-3 referrer prizes ₹1,000 / ₹600 / ₹400	A visible prize race keeps the leaderboard moving all week. We only pay if referrals happen.	₹2,000
Milestone rewards at 3 / 5 / 10 friends	AI Starter Kit, then a Campus AI Ambassador certificate (for LinkedIn), then a live shout-out with priority Q&A. All digital, so each extra reward costs nothing.	₹0
Tools	GitHub Pages hosting plus a Google Sheet backend through Apps Script.	₹0

Payout rule: a referral only counts toward the prizes if the friend is final-year and attends the workshop. This makes fake sign-ups worthless. **Considered and dropped:** paid ads (about 25–50 registrations) and one micro-influencer post (a one-day spike that we can't attribute to final-year students).

04 7-day calendar

DAY	PLAN	ACTIONS
Fri 30–Sat 31 Oct prep	0	Recruit 25 champions through college contacts, LinkedIn and the NxtWave community. Line up the 12 partners. Build one tracked link per group in the dashboard. Switch the backend live.
D1 · Sun 1 Nov	90	Champions post in their batch groups in the evening, which is likely the peak reading time. The leaderboard and prize race open.
D2 · Mon 2	85	Partner posts go out from clubs and placement cells, plus a LinkedIn post from the host. Push the WhatsApp Status card to everyone who registered on D1.
D3 · Tue 3	70	First leaderboard post and college-vs-college callout. Nudge the top 20 ambassadors with their progress. **Checkpoint:** pace and referral share.
D4 · Wed 4	60	Mid-week dip. Tell everyone at 1–2 referrals: "1 more friend unlocks the Starter Kit." Read the first test results (see form).
D5 · Thu 5	60	Put effort into the 3 best channels on the dashboard and drop the weakest. Second post only in groups converting at 4% or more.
D6 · Fri 6	65	"48 hours left in the prize race" leaderboard post. Top colleges race each other.
D7 · Sat 7	90	Deadline surge: "seats closing" message, final nudges. The prize race closes at 11:59 PM.
Sun 8 Nov workshop	n/a	WhatsApp reminders at 9:00 and 10:45 AM. Prizes are announced live, which gives people a reason to show up and not just register.

05 Metrics and decision rules

METRIC	TARGET	IF OFF TRACK
Registrations vs daily plan	≥ 90%	Below 80% two days running: add 8 champions or groups (about +80)
Referral share of registrations	≥ 30% by D3	Below 20%: nudge sharers, push the Status card, show the next milestone more prominently
Final-year share	≥ 80%	Below 70%: move effort from LinkedIn and clubs to batch groups
Group conversion (registrations ÷ members)	≥ 4%	Below 2% after 24 h: switch the message angle (Test 1)
Show-up rate on Sunday	≥ 40%	Add-to-calendar at sign-up, plus reminders on D7 and the morning of the workshop

06 Risks

- **Fake or self referrals:** the system blocks self-referrals and duplicate emails or phones, and only shows masked names. The payout rule (final-year and attended) removes the incentive to cheat.
- **Group fatigue or admins removing posts:** one post per group, made by a member of that group rather than an outsider. Second posts only go to groups that convert.
- **Registrations that never show up:** calendar invite, two reminders, and prizes revealed live.

WORKING ASSET: THE REFERRAL ENGINE THAT RUNS THIS PLAN

akilan-j.github.io/ai-workshop-referral-engine · /admin.html (dashboard)

- **Student page:** 30-second registration, a personal invite link, one-tap WhatsApp share, a personalised WhatsApp Status card with a QR code, rewards at 3, 5 and 10 friends, leaderboards for ambassadors and for colleges, and add-to-calendar.
- **Organiser dashboard:** pace vs this plan and a projected finish, attribution by channel and by group, final-year share, auto-generated "what to do next" actions, one-tap WhatsApp nudges to ambassadors, a tracked-link builder, and CSV export.

Reach and conversion figures are planning estimates. Two numbers get replaced with real ones first: the D1 group conversion and the D3 referral share.